Structured Tables

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Abstract

A short comparison of MyST's two table syntaxes, with examples of captioned, labelled list tables.

Use the `{list-table}` directive when a table needs a caption, a label, or complex cell content.

1. Comparing the formats

Feature	Pipe table	`{list-table}`
Caption	No	Yes
Cross-reference label	No	Yes
Multi-paragraph cells	No	Yes
Easy to read in source	Yes	Moderately

Table 1: Comparison of MyST table syntaxes

As Table 1 shows, list tables cost a little readability in the source and give you much more flexibility in return.

Important

Every row of a `{list-table}` must have the same number of items. A missing cell causes a build error rather than an empty cell.

2. Formulas in tables

Shape	Area
Circle	πr^2
Annulus	$\pi(r_2^2 - r_1^2)$
Triangle	$\frac{1}{2}bh$

Table 2: Areas of common shapes

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